

Selection logic

I did not pick the strongest engineers I know. I picked the three people who close the three weaknesses the 72-hour build actually exposed.

Gaps the prototype revealed

Usability Demo results were once mistaken for a real analysis because the warning was not visible enough. A screening tool that misleads its own user fails.

Fraud expertise An AI-generated invoice scored low risk. Knowing which fraud patterns matter, and what a false positive costs, is domain knowledge I do not have.

Production No rate limiting, a payload ceiling on the host, no persistence. The prototype runs; it is not yet a service.

1. Product and user experience

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Key capability Product thinking, UX/UI design, full-stack development.

Why him DocShield produces a correct analysis that a reviewer can still misread. Turning a risk score into a decision someone trusts is a product problem, not a model problem — and it is the part I am weakest on.

Role Design the verification workflow, the evidence presentation and the reviewer's decision path.

Potential He works across product and engineering, so he can argue with the constraint instead of designing around it. That combination is rare, and it is what turns a technical result into a usable one.

2. Fraud and security

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Key capability Cybersecurity, threat analysis, fraud detection.

Why him My tests proved the system misses well-made forgeries. Deciding which fraud patterns to prioritise, and where a false positive costs more than a miss, requires someone who has seen real fraud.

Role Define fraud scenarios, calibrate severity and the false-positive threshold, challenge the detection rules adversarially.

Potential He thinks like an attacker, which is the only reliable way to test a detection tool. Someone whose instinct is to break the system is worth more here than another builder.

3. Backend, cloud and MLOps

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Key capability Backend engineering, DevOps, cloud infrastructure, AI systems.

Why him The prototype has no rate limiting, no persistence and a payload ceiling on its host. Each of these is a production problem, and each one blocks a first paying customer.

Role Build the API, the infrastructure and the deployment pipeline; make the system scale and stay within cost.

Potential He covers software, DevOps and AI at once — a range that usually takes three people. On a small team, that breadth is the difference between shipping and stalling.

What this team would look like

Four people covering detection, product, adversarial testing and production, with me on the AI and detection side. Deliberately no second AI engineer — the prototype's failures were never a lack of modelling: they were a lack of usability, domain knowledge and operational rigour.